

Autistic language Bank

Categories Language Bank

Avatar - "Autistic Parent"

LANGUAGE BANK

POWER WORDS Individualized Education Program (IEP) Applied Behavior Analysis

(ABA) Pathological Demand Avoidance (PDA) NT = Neurotypical (NT kids)

Sensory Occupational Therapy (OT)

Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) sensory/motor issue / sensory issues

Accidents

Fully potty trained Pull Ups / Diaper

Leaks Accidents

Meltdowns No awareness Interoception Demand avoidance Stubborn Power

struggle Regression Hyper vigilant

TRIGGER PHRASES

(sentences that get response) "She'll pee herself and just keep playing."

My son screams and cries for chocolate and refuses to use the toilet to be treated with it.

I get so defeated I put his diaper back on.

Potty training is the absolute worst.

She is not showing any signs of readiness and is TERRIFIED of the potty.

how the heck do you potty train an autistic 3 year old

He'll start to pee and theeeen run (while peeing) to his potty 🤔 (or just stand there like WHAT DO I DO.)

I can't describe how many times I've gone on Reddit trying to figure out how it potty train them.

We're on day 2 of I don't even remember how many attempts at this point. I hate it.

We're on round...who knows what of potty training too, and it's brutal

If I try prompting her she just freaks out and refuses to sit on the toilet.

I don't want to deal with power struggles 7 times a day either.

"He freaks out the second I suggest the potty."

Potty training my son was a mess

"I can't afford pull-ups forever."

potty training hell

She'll just continue to play in the pee. She doesn't care.

„I'm starting to feel ashamed when other parents see his diaper poke out of his pants at the playground.“

„She'll pee herself and just keep playing in the puddle.“

My son is autistic as well and dribbles a lot and withholds his pee forever.

he cries because he's so in pain from holding it and it won't come out.

We almost got divorced lol

I feel like giving up potty training our ASD 4 yo. It's so hard.

(pooping related) We had a few hard weeks where he wasn't sleeping at night, just running around his room, we thought we were losing our minds...

Potty Training Nightmare

Children with autism often have misfires between their brain and their bladders.

I'm so sick of cleaning up shit. (note: should be turned into pee)

My partner is FURIOUS at me that she isn't potty trained

Finally done, finally being able to communicate 🐛 and pee 😭!!

He refused to go to the potty. meltdowns about having to go so frequently.

I just can't seem to get him to consistently use the potty.

We definitely struggle with some demand avoidance, not full blown PDA but pretty close.

These past three years have been hell

We did stay in for a week and it was absolute hell,

What can take a NT child weeks to learn, takes months or years for our kids so ANYTHING that can speed up very important milestones for our kids is a plus.

She knew how to go, but she just didn't want to.

She struggles with interoception, so she doesn't seem to really understand when she needs to pee.

He doesn't care about peeing himself one bit, or what else he gets soaked in pee.

we thought we were losing our minds...

I don't want to resort to bribery, but I'm literally at a loss of what to do.

We try for a few days just to sit fully clothed and it leads to a panic attack.

Dude potty training suuuuucks!!

We gave up and let the ABA therapist try it.

My son is apparently doing great at ABA and is basically potty trained there but at home he screams and won't even go near the potty. 🤔🤔🤔🤔🤔

Children with autism often have misfires between their brain and their bladders.

METAPHORS

(How they describe the feeling) "I feel like giving up."

Defeat. That's what I feel.

I felt as though our son would be in diapers forever

"This is driving me insane."

„...I'm starting to feel ashamed when other parents see his diaper poke out of his pants at the playground."

I feel like we have tried everything, reward systems, punishments and nothing seems to work.

I absolutely lost it. I yelled at him and smacked his butt. I'm an emotional wreck right now.

It was a struggle but since January we've been working hard 😞.

I feel like a failure because he's still in pull ups.

it was brutal, nothing we read and no advice we received worked.

My wife was desperate.

his mom tried potty training him but gave up because she's not that patient with him.

The timeline for an autistic kid is not the same as an NT child, so we've been told not to rush it.

He's fairly high functioning and seems ready, but I'm just at a loss and feel like giving up.

he had constant accidents and would have massive meltdowns if we asked him to try and use the toilet at regular intervals

SCENE DESCRIPTIONS

(specific moments) Sitting on the potty... nothing happens... then peeing on the floor 10 minutes later.

Holding it for hours until it physically spills out.

Pre-drip running down his leg.

Standing there mid-pee like "what do I do?"

Running while peeing to the potty.

Peeing right in front of the bathroom.

Peeing and continuing to play.

Screaming when asked to sit.

Rolling on the floor to avoid pulling pants up.

Sitting on the potty watching Bluey but not releasing.

Changing pants 10 times a day.

Parent hyper-vigilantly watching body cues.

Parent counting the minutes between attempts.

"Time to go potty." → immediate meltdown.

Parent pretending it's a "secret pee."

FAILED SOLUTIONS

(what they have tried) Timers every 15-30 minutes

Sitting schedules

Forcing success (rushing to toilet mid-pee)

Reward charts

Candy bribes

Sticker systems

Toys for pee

Screen time on the toilet

Books next to the potty

Songs (Elmo, Cocomelon)

Bare bottom method

Underwear under pull-ups

Taking diapers away cold turkey

Leaving diapers on at night

Juice loading

Salty snacks to increase output

Bubbles to "relax and release"

Running water sounds

Potty in every room

OT support

Early intervention

Waiting it out

Making them clean it up

Ignoring accidents

Over-the-top celebration

Being neutral and calm

(Individualized Education Program (IEP)

Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA))

OBJECTIONS

(what stops them) "Maybe she's just not ready."

"What if I'm pushing too hard?"

"She refuses and I'm not about to force her"

"If I wait longer, will it be worse?"

"What if he starts kindergarten in pull-ups?"

"I can't afford pull-ups anymore."

"I don't want school to shame him."

"I don't want this to become a power struggle."

"I don't want him to become potty-averse."

"I don't know if this is sensory or behavioral."

"Is this interoception or stubbornness?"

"How do I know if it's refusal or inability?"

"We can't live like this forever."

"I feel like I'm failing."

"Why does this seem so easy for other parents?"

"We took time off everything for this."

"If this doesn't work, I don't know what will."

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sensory/motor issue